

Ranking India's Greatest Men's T20I Batting Innings: A Tier List

Numbers do not tell everything. It is the impact that gives us a bigger picture. This is the ultimate tier list of top Indian T20 batting innings. From Gambhir's incredible 75 not out in the final of the 2007 T20 World Cup to Karthik's 8-ball 29 against Bangladesh in the Nidahas Trophy final, we have ranked them all.

S-Tier

The Untouchables.

Virat Kohli - 82 not out (53) vs Pakistan, MCG, 2022 T20 World Cup

India were 31 for 4 in the sixth over, chasing 160 in front of 90,000 fans, when Kohli walked out and rebuilt the innings almost single-handedly. His two consecutive sixes off Haris Rauf in the penultimate over turned an impossible equation into a manageable one, and Ravichandran Ashwin scrambled home the winning run off the final ball. Kohli himself called it the best T20 innings of his career. This was a special innings considering he was well short of runs coming into the World Cup.

Virat Kohli - 82 not out (51) vs Australia, Mohali, 2016 T20 World Cup

How can this be ignored?! A virtual quarter-final, and India needed 161 against an attack featuring Mitchell Starc and Nathan Coulter-Nile. Kohli anchored the chase through an early stumble to 49 for 3, then exploded late, taking Faulkner to the cleaners and finishing off Faulkner's T20 career. MS Dhoni did the rest and India qualified for the semi-finals.

Yuvraj Singh - 70 (30) vs Australia, Durban, 2007 T20 World Cup semi-final

Before his six sixes against England became folklore, Yuvraj produced an even more important innings days later, a 30-ball 70 against the reigning 50-over world champions in a knockout game, including a 119-metre six off Brett Lee. His stand with Robin Uthappa dragged India from 41 for 2 to a match-winning 188, sending them through to the inaugural final.

Sanju Samson - 97 not out (50) vs West Indies, Kolkata, 2026 Super Eight

Recalled to the XI after being dropped for three straight games, Samson answered every critic with the innings of his career. A tactically brilliant innings, brilliantly paced with top-notch strike rotation. It was perfect, considering his horrible form coming into the World Cup.

A+ Tier

Tournament-defining brilliance.

Sanju Samson - 89 (46) vs New Zealand, Ahmedabad, 2026 Final

In the final act of India's title defence, Samson and Abhishek Sharma put together the first fifty-plus opening stand in a T20 World Cup final, and Samson's 46-ball 89, which was his 3rd

consecutive 80-plus score, took India to a strong position. India won by 96 runs to become the first team to successfully defend the trophy.

Sanju Samson - 89 (42) vs England, Mumbai, 2026 semi-final

Samson followed his Kolkata heroics with an even faster innings, striking seven sixes in 42 balls to help set up a total of 253 in a match where nearly 500 runs were scored across both innings. Having been put down by Brook at deep mid-on off Archer's bowling, he completely took the opportunity and played a blinder.

Rohit Sharma - 92 (41) vs Australia, St Lucia, 2024 Super Eight

India's highest total of the 2024 World Cup was built almost single-handedly by their captain. Watching this innings live felt like a personal victory. The slower ball by Cummins, which was absolutely tanked by Rohit over the deep mid-wicket region, was special. He missed out on the century, but it did feel like the day Rohit had finally put his 2023 World Cup final demons to rest.

Yuvraj Singh - 58 (16) vs England, Durban, 2007 T20 World Cup

One of the most iconic T20 innings ever. Yuvraj Singh smashed 58 off just 16 balls against England in the 2007 T20 World Cup, including six sixes in a single over. In barely a few minutes, he turned the momentum completely in India's favour and delivered a performance that became part of cricketing history. Flintoff might still be regretting this.

A-Tier

Match-winners with real stakes.

Suresh Raina - 101 (60) vs South Africa, St Lucia, 2010

India's first T20I century came against an attack featuring Dale Steyn, with Raina scoring just 19 off his first 22 balls before exploding for 82 off his last 38.

Gautam Gambhir - 75 (54) vs Pakistan, Johannesburg, 2007 Final

In the first-ever T20 World Cup final, Gambhir was the only Indian batter to truly get set, carrying the innings to 157 while wickets fell steadily at the other end. Gambhir and finals are a truly special combination, with him playing the clutch role beautifully.

Rohit Sharma - 118 (43) vs Sri Lanka, Indore, 2017

This is still the fastest T20 century by an Indian in the shortest format. It was absolute carnage from The Hitman that day. To be honest, the Sri Lankans always have a piece of Rohit Sharma every now and then. With a total of 10 sixes, and at the pace he was going, it felt as if 200 was possible that day.

Virat Kohli - 72 not out (44) vs South Africa, Dhaka, 2014 semi-final

Chasing 173 against an attack led by Dale Steyn, Kohli played a tactical masterclass on a comparatively hard pitch. Just three dot balls were faced across the whole innings, and he finished off the chase with the famous moment from Dhoni, handing him the strike for the last over.

B+ Tier

Brilliant, but bittersweet.

Dinesh Karthik - 29 not out (8) vs Bangladesh, Colombo, 2018 Nidahas Trophy Final

India needed 34 off the last 12 balls when Karthik walked in at No. 7. He took two sixes and a four off Rubel Hossain's penultimate over to close the gap, then finished it off with a last-ball six against Soumya Sarkar. This innings cemented his place for the 2019 World Cup, with no real finisher knocking on the Indian selectors' door at that time.

Suryakumar Yadav - 84 not out (49) vs USA, Mumbai, 2026 World Cup opener

India's title defence nearly stumbled at the first hurdle when a top-order collapse left them 77 for 6. Captain Suryakumar, dropped on 17, rebuilt the innings alone, smashing 21 runs off the final over and dragging India to a defendable score. SKY at Wankhede is always special.

Virat Kohli - 49 (51) vs Pakistan, Mirpur, 2016 Asia Cup

It's really easy to overlook this innings, but those who saw it live know better. Mohammad Amir was ripping through the Indian top order on his return from his fixing scandal, and it was Kohli, like always, playing his usual masterclass in a different tempo this time.

Thanks for the read.